Chapter-wise Detailed Notes — Making, salient features and philosophy of the Indian Constitution

Indian Government & Politics · Unit 1 · Chapter Making, salient features and philosophy of the Indian Constitution

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Chapter Study Notes

Learning focus

The Constituent Assembly debated and framed the Constitution; it was adopted on 26 November 1949 and came into force on 26 January 1950.

1. The Drafting Committee was chaired by Dr B. R. Ambedkar. Constitution-making involved debates over representation, rights, federalism, minority protection and social transformation.

2. Salient features include a written and detailed Constitution, parliamentary government, federal arrangements with a strong Union, republican democracy, independent judiciary and constitutional supremacy.

3. The Preamble expresses commitments including justice, liberty, equality and fraternity. The Constitution combines individual rights with goals for social and economic transformation.

4. Its philosophy must be understood through the Preamble, Fundamental Rights, Directive Principles, institutional design and the continuing interpretation of constitutional provisions.

Revision checklist

■ Can I define the key concept in my own words?

■ Can I explain its main features and distinguish it from related concepts?

■ Can I support an argument with a relevant example, thinker or constitutional provision?

■ Can I discuss at least one limitation or counterargument?